APEX EXCHANGE · CTV REVENUE RECONCILIATION

Recover $4.7M a year that DSP billing gaps take from Apex's P&L

Close faster, recover more: an AI copilot for Finance and Billing Operations, on one governed platform

For: CFO / VP Revenue Accounting · Director of Billing Operations · VP Data Engineering

Apex Exchange is fictional; all data is synthetic.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Apex loses 14% of its net revenue to DSP billing gaps each quarter. Most of it is recoverable faster.

TODAY (Q3 2026)

$8.9M
Apex net exposure per quarter
14% of Q3 net revenue ($61.9M), after publisher pass-through

21 days
to resolve one dispute
p90: 33 days · ~270 cases a month

55%
right root cause on first look
Analysts' rules of thumb on the 715 Q3 cases

WITH THE COPILOT

$4.7M / yr
back to Apex's P&L
Every recoverable case pursued, not ~60%

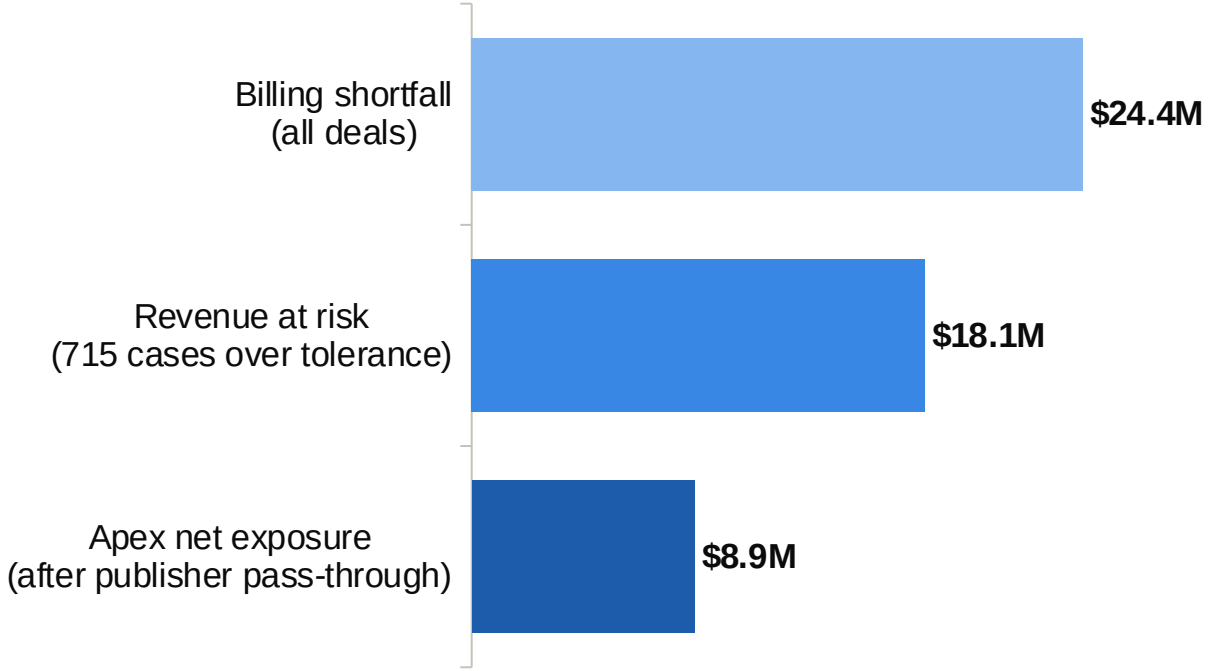
≤ 7 days
dispute cycle target
≈ $2.8M cash released once

92%
right root cause
Model on the same 715 cases · ≈ 3 FTE redeployed

THE PROBLEM

A $24M billing shortfall in Q3. $8.9M of it comes out of Apex's own P&L.

From the gap with DSPs to Apex's own loss, Q3 2026



Gross CTV spend in Q3 was $432M; Apex keeps a 14.3% take ($61.9M net revenue). The shortfall is 5.7% of gross; the exposure is 14% of Apex's net.

Who absorbs the gap depends on the publisher's terms

Paid on Apex's count

279 cases · $7.3M at risk

Apex still owes the publisher: **all $7.3M is Apex's loss**

Paid on cleared revenue

436 cases · $10.8M at risk

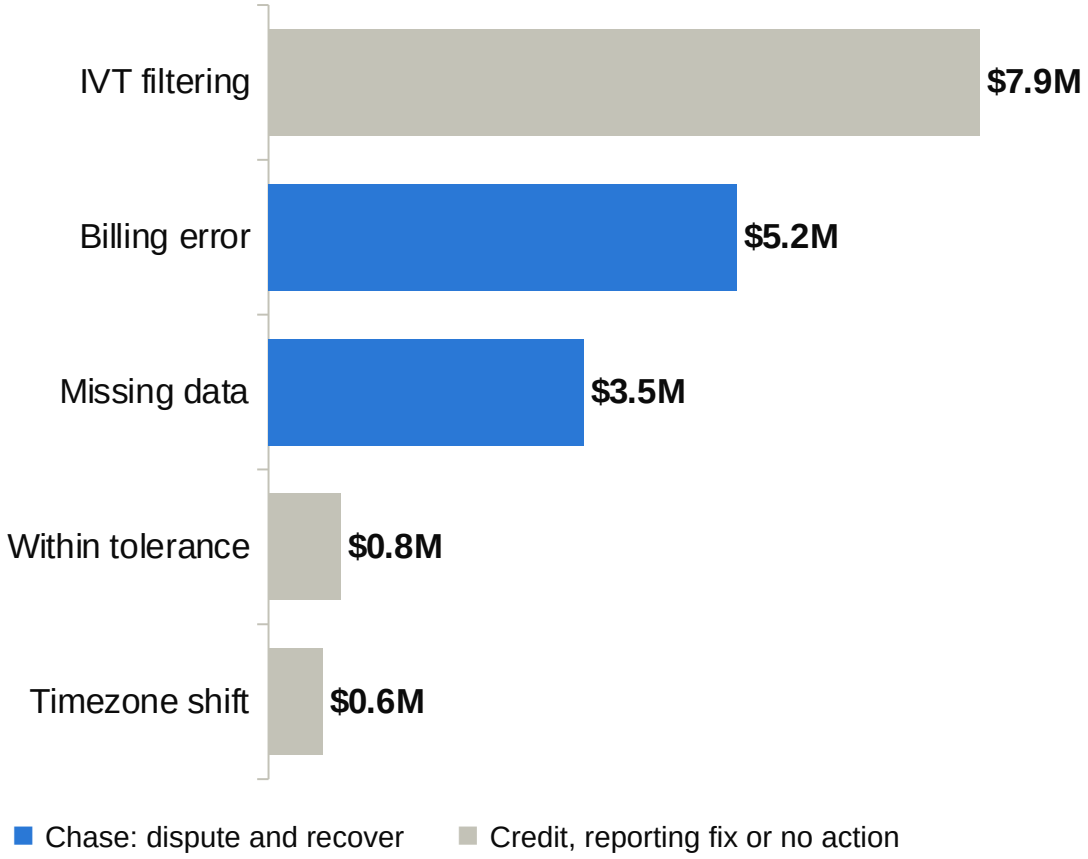
The publisher absorbs most of it: **Apex loses $1.6M** (its take), plus publisher goodwill

39 of 40 DSPs had at least one case. Top 5 DSPs = 38% of revenue at risk.

WHY THE COUNTS DON'T MATCH

Five root causes, each with a different fix. Only two are worth chasing.

Q3 revenue at risk by root cause (model's call)



Billing error

Unexplained under-reporting on some days

Dispute with log evidence · 60% recovered historically

Missing data

Days missing from the DSP's report

Get the days, then bill · 90% recovered

IVT filtering

DSP's fraud vendor removes spoofed CTV traffic

Credit only third-party-verified IVT

Timezone shift

DSP reports in US time; primetime crosses midnight UTC

Ask for UTC reporting; no billing change

Within tolerance

Daily noise flagged the deal; the month is within contract

No action

348 cases / $8.5M are IVT or timezone: a credit or a reporting fix, not a chase.

HOW IT WORKS FOR BILLING OPS

From spreadsheets and guesswork to one ranked queue with the cause and the draft ready

TODAY

Download each DSP's file → spreadsheet lookups → guess the cause (right 55% of the time) → email back and forth for 21 days → write off what's left

1

Ingest & check

Partner files land and are quality-checked the same day

Lakeflow

2

Reconcile

Every deal vs. Apex's logs, daily and monthly, with Apex's net exposure

Unity Catalog

3

Explain

A model names the root cause; AI drafts the dispute from the evidence

ML + GenAI

4

Resolve

Analysts work one ranked queue; every action is logged

App + Lakebase

5

Ask

Finance asks questions in plain English, on governed numbers

Genie

THE RECONCILIATION WORKBENCH

Two September cases with similar gaps: one costs Apex 6× more than the other

Mosaic Bid

Bluebird TV OS · Entertainment PMP

Gap with the DSP

$252,043

Apex net exposure

$33,774



13% of the gap hits Apex's P&L

Model: **Billing error (100%)**

23% gap vs 5% threshold · Publisher paid on cleared revenue · 13.4% take

Dispute it, but it's not the priority for Apex's P&L

Umbra Ads

Pinecrest Kids TV · Sports PMP

Gap with the DSP

$203,794

Apex net exposure

$203,794



100% of the gap hits Apex's P&L

Model: **IVT filtering (100%)**

16% gap vs 5% threshold · Publisher paid on Apex's count

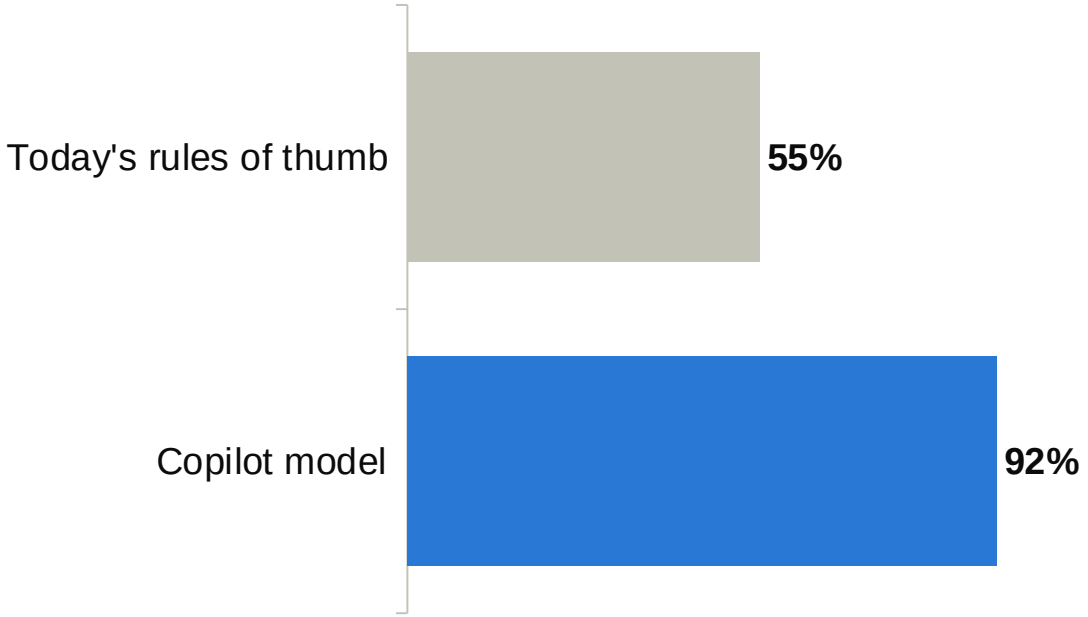
Every dollar is Apex's: credit only verified IVT, recover the rest

In the app: Close overview (shortfall, revenue at risk, Apex exposure, recovered) · Triage queue ranked by dollars, with the model's cause · Case detail with evidence, AI summary and an editable dispute email · Ask Genie

AI YOU CAN CHECK

The model is right 92% of the time on the cases analysts work, vs. 55% today

Right root cause on the 715 Q3 review cases (vs. true cause)



Macro F1 0.91 vs 0.41. Trained on 1,615 resolved Jan–Jun disputes (with ~11% analyst labelling mistakes, like real life), tested on Jul–Sep. Analysts confirm or override every call, and that feedback retrains the model.

250	dispute drafts from a JSON evidence pack, Claude via ai_query
100%	of dollar figures traced back to the evidence
100%	consistent with each contract's billing basis
4.7 / 5	accuracy from an independent AI judge (n = 30)
14 / 14	finance questions Genie answered correctly vs. reference SQL

IMPACT ON YOUR KPIS

≈ $4.7M a year to Apex's P&L, ≈ $2.8M of cash released and ≈ 3 analysts' capacity back

KPI	Owner	Baseline (Q3 2026)	Target	Annual value
Net revenue recovered	CFO	$3.0M recoverable to Apex's P&L per quarter; ~60% of cases worked today*	Pursue every recoverable case	**≈ $4.7M / year to P&L (≈ $10M gross cash)**
Dispute cycle time / DSO	CFO	21 days avg · 33 days p90	≤ 7 days	**≈ $2.8M cash released once (~$200K/day × 14 days)**
Analyst effort	Billing Ops	~270 cases/month × ~2.5 h* ≈ 4.2 FTE	~45 min per case	**≈ 3 FTE redeployed**
Right fix first time	Billing Ops	Right cause 55% of the time	92% (model)	**348 cases/quarter go straight to a credit or reporting fix**
Month-end close	CFO	~10 business days*	~4 days	**Faster, auditable close**

* Assumptions to validate in discovery: today's coverage (60%), effort per case (2.5 h), close length (10 days), and publisher payment terms by deal. Everything else is computed from the build's data.

WHAT IT COSTS TO RUN

≈ $55K a year to run at full volume, for ≈ $4.7M a year to the P&L

~85×

annual return

$4.7M to Apex's P&L vs ≈ $55K run cost, before cash and capacity gains

$3.80

per full daily run, measured

Ingest, reconcile, retrain the model and draft 250 disputes in ~9 minutes

Component	Measured on this build (list price)	Annual estimate
Daily build: pipeline, model, AI drafts	≈ $3.80 per run (6 runs in October)	≈ $1.4K
Reconciliation Workbench app	≈ $11 per day, always on	≈ $4K
Lakebase case store + sync	< $1 for the month	negligible
Total at build scale		**≈ $5.4K**
Budget at Apex's full volume (10×)		**≈ $55K**

Measured from Databricks system billing tables for this build (evidence/11_build_cost). All compute is serverless and can be capped with budget policies. The SQL warehouse is shared, so it isn't included.

WHAT EACH OF YOU GETS

One platform, three wins

CFO / VP Revenue Accounting

More net revenue, sooner

≈ $4.7M a year to the P&L, plus faster collection

Your real exposure

Every gap split into what Apex absorbs vs. what passes through, by partner, deal and cause

Audit-ready controls

Lineage from partner file to invoice; every analyst action logged; Finance-only dollars

Director of Billing Operations

One ranked queue

Work the dollars that hit Apex first

Right cause, ready draft

92% right on first look; dispute drafted from evidence and contract

By the book

Credit only verified IVT; bad partner files caught on arrival

VP Data Engineering

One governed platform

Ingest, ML, case workflow and NL questions without copying data across tools

Policies in the platform

Row filters and masks on every table, including Genie's

Simple to run

One bundle, one serverless job, ~9 minutes a day

HOW IT'S BUILT, AND PROOF IT RUNS

End to end on Databricks, from raw partner files to the analyst's workbench

Lakeflow

Auto Loader + declarative pipeline · bronze → silver → gold · 4 data-quality rules

›

Unity Catalog

Row filters + column masks on every queryable table · tags · lineage

›

ML + GenAI

Root-cause model in MLflow @champion · Claude drafts via ai_query, auto-checked

›

Lakebase

Postgres case store: status, audit trail, credits · live in Unity Catalog

›

Genie

Plain-English questions on the same governed numbers

›

Databricks App

Reconciliation Workbench for Finance and Billing Ops

PROOF FROM THE COMMITTED RUN OUTPUT

3.57M

hourly log rows · 158K DSP report rows · 9 months · 40 DSPs · 800 deals

1,728

bad partner rows caught by the quality rules before billing

92% · 0.91

model accuracy · macro F1 on the 715 Q3 cases

14 / 14

Genie answers match reference SQL

PASS

app test: open → send → resolve with a verified IVT credit, live in Lakebase and UC

ROLLOUT PLAN AND NEXT STEPS

A 30-day pilot on the top 5 DSPs, with success criteria agreed up front

DAYS 0–30

Pilot

Top 5 DSPs (38% of revenue at risk) on Apex's real files, alongside the spreadsheets

Success: Root-cause agreement with analysts ≥ 85%

DAYS 31–60

Scale

All 40 DSPs; analysts sign in with their own access (on-behalf-of-user)

Success: Cycle time ≤ 10 days

DAYS 61–90

Run

Retire the spreadsheet process; retrain on analyst-confirmed causes

Success: Cycle time ≤ 7 days, close ≤ 4 days

WHAT WE'RE ASKING FOR

1. **Discovery session with Billing Ops** to confirm coverage, effort per case, close length and publisher payment terms
2. **One month of data** auction log extracts + billing files for the top 5 DSPs
3. **A pilot sponsor** in Revenue Accounting, with a day-30 readout on recovered dollars and cycle time